

DANCEFLOW

ARIA Operations Expanded Setup Guide

For studios ready to move beyond the first-week setup

Build in layers.

The goal is not to automate everything. The goal is to create a dependable operations rhythm, then expand only where ARIA consistently saves time.

Recommended after: one week of comfortable daily use

1. Before You Expand

Move beyond the starter setup only when the first-week workflow feels predictable. You should already be comfortable reviewing, assigning, approving, snoozing, skipping, dismissing, and completing actions.

You are ready when:

- The primary owner checks ARIA Operations most days.
- The team understands the difference between approval and completion.
- Actions are not regularly left unassigned.
- The morning digest is being received and read.
- ARIA recommendations generally match real studio needs.
- Staff understands which actions require human judgment.

Pause expansion when needed

If the queue still feels confusing, keep the starter setup for another week. A simple workflow that is used consistently is better than an advanced workflow that staff avoids.

2. The Expanded Setup Model

The expanded setup has four layers. Add one layer at a time.

Layer	Focus	Primary outcome	Typical timing
1	Ownership	Every action has a clear responsible person.	Week 2
2	Digest rhythm	The team sees the right information at the right time.	Week 2
3	Policy tuning	Low-risk work moves faster while risky work stays reviewed.	Weeks 2–3
4	Automation	Selected actions are approved and queued automatically.	Week 3+

3. How ARIA Operations and Automations Work Together

ARIA Operations and **Automations** both help the studio follow through, but they should be configured separately.

Workspace	Primary purpose	Automation behavior
ARIA Operations	Turns live business signals into prioritized actions, assignments, digests, and review decisions.	Supported ARIA actions can be auto-approved and queued by the scheduled ARIA Operations runner.
Automations	Runs recurring studio rules and creates suggestions, editable drafts, or automatic outbound messages.	Each rule has its own enabled state and Suggestion, Draft, or Auto-send mode.
Automation Drafts	Provides a review workspace for messages created in Draft mode.	Staff can edit and queue messages before delivery.

Important distinction

ARIA auto-approval does not depend on the Automations page. For supported ARIA rules, the scheduled ARIA Operations process can generate, approve, and queue the follow-up. Automations is a separate recurring-rule system with its own templates and delivery modes.

Recommended combined setup sequence

1. Stabilize ARIA ownership, policies, and digest delivery first.
2. Review the Automations page and enable only rules that match the studio's real workflow.
3. Begin recurring rules in Suggestion or Draft mode.
4. Review generated actions and Automation Drafts for at least one week.
5. Move a proven Automations rule to Auto-send only after its recipients, template, timing, and results are verified.

Avoid duplicate follow-up

Before enabling an Automations rule, confirm that an ARIA policy is not already producing a similar client follow-up. Use one primary workflow for each business need.

4. Layer 1: Expand Ownership

The first expansion should be ownership, not auto-approval. Clear ownership reduces missed follow-up and prevents multiple staff members from assuming someone else handled the work.

Recommended ownership assignments

Action type	Suggested owner	Reason
Booking requests	Front desk or scheduler	They can quickly confirm availability and reply.
Low package balances	Sales lead or owner	They can guide renewals and next-step purchases.
Stale students	Instructor or client-care lead	A personal rebooking message is often most effective.
Intro without purchase	Instructor or sales lead	They understand the student's goals and objections.
Membership billing	Owner or billing manager	Billing issues require careful review.
Event registration issues	Organizer manager	They own registration and event-day readiness.
Event finance issues	Owner or finance lead	Profitability and missing costs require

		business judgment.
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Ownership setup steps

- Choose a default owner for each policy.
- Use Require assignment only after every policy has a reliable owner.
- Review the Staff Ownership Dashboard at least twice per week.
- Reassign overdue work instead of letting it remain unowned.
- Keep financial and billing work assigned to a manager-level role.

Best practice

For a small studio, two ownership groups are usually enough: customer follow-up and business/financial review.

5. Layer 2: Expand the Digest Rhythm

Once the morning digest is useful, decide whether the team benefits from a second summary.

Morning digest

- Keep enabled for the primary owner or manager.
- Schedule it before the normal workday begins.
- Use it to choose the day’s top 1–3 priorities.

End-of-day digest

- Enable only when the team needs a carryover summary.
- Schedule it 30–60 minutes before the studio closes.
- Use it to identify overdue work and items rolling into tomorrow.

Who should receive digests?

Studio size	Morning recipient	End-of-day recipient
Solo owner	Owner	Usually off or owner
Small team	Owner or front desk lead	Front desk lead or owner
Larger studio	Operations manager	Operations manager and/or owner
Organizer workspace	Organizer manager	Organizer manager or finance lead

6. Layer 3: Tune Policies by Risk

Not every ARIA policy should behave the same way. Group policies by risk and expected staff involvement.

Low-risk policies

These are the best candidates for eventual ARIA auto-approval because the recommendation is straightforward and the supported ARIA execution path can queue an appropriate follow-up.

- Low package balances
- Stale active students
- Intro without purchase

Medium-risk policies

These may use ARIA auto-approval or a separate Automations rule later, but they usually benefit from assignment and review first.

- Aging booking requests
- Canceling memberships
- Low event check-in quality

High-risk policies

Keep these in manual review unless the workflow changes significantly.

- Payment exceptions
- Past-due memberships
- Event registration payment issues
- Event losses
- Missing event costs

Guardrail

Auto-approval does not mean ARIA makes financial changes. It means an approved, email-safe follow-up may enter the outbound queue. Billing, refunds, pricing, and accounting decisions remain human-controlled.

7. Layer 4: Introduce Auto-Approval Carefully

Enable ARIA auto-approval for only one supported policy at a time. This is separate from enabling Auto-send on the Automations page. Keep each workflow in observation for at least one week before expanding further.

Recommended first auto-approval sequence

1	Low package balances Clear renewal signal and easy to verify.
2	Stale active students

	Useful rebooking prompt with low operational risk.
3	Intro without purchase Good conversion follow-up when wording is appropriate.
4	Canceling memberships Use only after reviewing message tone and ownership.

Auto-approval settings

- Set the policy to Auto-approve.
- Choose the lowest practical maximum priority first.
- Assign a default owner.
- Enable Require assignment when ownership is dependable.
- Review queued ARIA actions, Automation Drafts, and outbound delivery results during the first week of any new automation.

Start with normal priority

Do not begin by auto-approving urgent or high-priority actions. Expand the maximum priority only after the studio has verified the policy's behavior.

8. Configure Maximum Auto-Approval Priority

The maximum priority setting limits which recommendations ARIA can approve automatically. It does not change the mode of rules on the separate Automations page.

Maximum level	What it allows	Recommended use
Low only	Only low-priority recommendations	Very cautious testing
Normal	Low and normal recommendations	Best starting point
High	Includes high-priority recommendations	Only after proven reliability
Urgent	Includes every priority	Not recommended for routine auto-approval

9. Build an Action Review Standard

Create a simple internal standard so different staff members handle ARIA actions consistently.

Before approving an action, confirm:

- The source record is accurate.
- The client or event still needs follow-up.
- The action is assigned to the right person.
- The message or next step is appropriate.
- No recent staff activity has already resolved the issue.

Before marking an action done, confirm:

- The follow-up or operational task actually occurred.
- Any related client, payment, booking, or event record is updated.
- Notes are added when the outcome may matter later.
- The action does not need to be snoozed for a second follow-up.

10. Use Snooze, Skip, and Dismiss Consistently

Choice	Meaning	Example
Snooze	The action is valid, but the timing is wrong.	A student asked to be contacted next week.
Skip	The action is valid, but the studio is intentionally not acting.	The client is already in a personal conversation.
Dismiss	The recommendation is not useful or no longer accurate.	The record was outdated or incorrectly categorized.

11. Weekly ARIA Operations Review

Set aside 15–20 minutes once per week to improve the workflow.

Review these items:

- Open and overdue actions by owner.
- Unassigned actions.
- Snoozed actions returning soon.
- Actions completed during the week.
- Policies creating too many or too few recommendations.
- Auto-approved actions that were later skipped or dismissed.
- Digest runs and outbound delivery status.

Weekly decisions

- Should any policy owner change?
- Should a policy remain manual or move to auto-approval?
- Should the maximum auto-approval priority change?
- Should a digest be enabled, disabled, or rescheduled?
- Are there recurring issues that require a process change outside ARIA?

Use ARIA as a process mirror

Repeated recommendations often reveal a studio process problem. For example, frequent aging booking requests may mean the front-desk review routine needs improvement.

12. Recommended Expanded Configuration

Policy	Mode	Maximum priority	Default owner
Low package balances	Auto-approve	Normal	Sales/owner
Stale active students	Auto-approve	Normal	Client care/instructor
Intro without purchase	Auto-approve or manual	Normal	Sales/instructor
Aging booking requests	Manual review	—	Front desk
Canceling memberships	Manual review	—	Owner
Past-due memberships	Manual review	—	Billing manager
Payment exceptions	Manual review	—	Owner/billing
Event payment issues	Manual review	—	Organizer manager
Event financial issues	Manual review	—	Owner/finance

13. Expanded Setup Checklist

- ☐ Assign default owners by action category.
- ☐ Review the Staff Ownership Dashboard twice per week.
- ☐ Enable the end-of-day digest only when it adds value.
- ☐ Group policies into low, medium, and high risk.
- ☐ Choose one low-risk policy for auto-approval.
- ☐ Set the first maximum auto-approval level to Normal or lower.
- ☐ Require assignment before generation only after ownership is stable.
- ☐ Review queued and sent deliveries from both ARIA Operations and Automations during the first week.
- ☐ Review enabled Automations rules, templates, Drafts, and delivery modes.
- ☐ Hold a weekly ARIA Operations review.
- ☐ Expand one policy at a time.

14. Signs the Setup Needs Adjustment

- The same actions are repeatedly dismissed.
- Too many actions remain unassigned.
- Staff is approving actions without reading the source details.
- Auto-approved actions are frequently skipped later.
- The team ignores one or both digests.
- Financial or billing actions are being handled by the wrong role.
- The Operations Center again feels overwhelming.

Simplify when necessary

Turn off one digest, return a policy to manual review, or reduce the maximum auto-approval priority. Expansion should remain reversible.

15. Long-Term Operating Rhythm

Frequency	Activity	Owner
Daily	Review digest and top-priority actions	Operations owner
During the day	Complete, assign, snooze, skip, or dismiss work	Assigned staff
Twice weekly	Review overdue and unassigned actions	Manager
Weekly	Tune policies, owners, and digest settings	Owner/manager
Monthly	Review recurring patterns and business-process gaps	Owner

Final principle

ARIA should make the studio feel more organized, not more complicated. Keep the configuration only as advanced as the team can use confidently.

DanceFlow • Clear ownership, safer automation, stronger follow-through